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which has been great in injecting some discipline into the open source arena, to the extent that open source is now leading the way in providing a really good disciplined practice for developing software. So, lots of companies, including Pega, have started adopting these practices.

Q How has your hiring pattern changed over the past one year, as there has been a spurt of new technologies?

I wouldn't say that it has changed radically, though it may have accelerated in certain areas. We have our core development people who build our core enterprise platform but we also have developers who build products on this platform in various business areas, for example, in healthcare, communications, insurance, financial services, etc. We have made some investments in growing the applications side of the business last year. We have accelerated hiring people who are building applications and some of those people are probably less technical. We bring people from a business background so they understand insurance, financial services and communications. They can use our platform because it is so easy to use that people don't necessarily need to have a computer science degree.

There is a company in the US that specialises in taking people who do not have a computer science background. These people are majors in philosophy, music, English, etc, but they are smart people. One of the advantages is that today, everybody who comes out of college has some exposure to computers and technology. They take these people and they train them in Pega technology and then they put them to work in Pega development projects. This means they make a lot more money than they would as music or English majors. Also, there is a shortage of people who have Pega skills in the market. So this company does that very successfully. We have been talking with a few companies in India who are interested in doing the same thing. Hopefully, we will start to see some of that soon.

Q Last year, when my colleague met you at the same event, you had mentioned some of your expansion plans. How much have you expanded in the past one year?

In Bengaluru, we just opened a new floor. We had completely filled the space we had in Bengaluru because the Antenna acquisition brought in about 100 people. We acquired another company called MeshLabs, which does

social analytics. It monitors all social media channels and does a sentiment analysis—identifying whether the tweets are positive or negative; this is important as companies monitor tweets since they are looking for those who are unhappy with their products or services. That way, they can reach out and fix the problem, or if someone is happy, they can enhance their customer satisfaction levels. We have also continued to hire and grow the team in Bengaluru, where we now have between 200 to 300 people.

At Hyderabad, things are even more chaotic. Every inch of space in the office is packed because we have just grown and grown. We are just on the cusp of moving to a bigger facility—from the DLF building where we are currently, to a new building in Mindspace. This will give us the space to nearly double the capacity that we have in Hyderabad.

Q Apart from Hyderabad and Bengaluru, do you plan to expand to other cities in India?

No, not at this moment. The reason we are in India is because we have great talent here. As long as we continue to find great talent in Hyderabad, we will continue to grow in that city and the same is true for Bengaluru. If there is some compelling reason to go somewhere else, then we are open to it. But having a presence in multiple locations means we have to co-ordinate and make people feel connected, which as a company we are very good at, but we are also careful when we do that.

Q By how much do you plan to increase your developers strength in the coming years?

It is tough to say...we are planning for a capacity that is double our current level. We don't have a timeframe as to when it will happen but one of our primary focus areas is growth in India.

Q With the arrival of the new technologies mentioned earlier, how has your hiring pattern changed with respect to freshers?

We run an internship programme, courtesy which, last year we took on 25 people. We take them as interns in their last year, they work for us and then they become part of Pega. We do pay them stipends and when they graduate, they come and work for us.

Q In this conference, you seem to have restricted yourself to the developers of the companies that are your customers. As I believe, there is a big community of third party and independent developers in India. So why aren't you focusing on them? And if you are targeting them, how do you plan to tap them?

Well, for the first time this year, we ran the Java developers' session at the Pega Developers' Conference. So, the people who came for this session have no experience working with Pega at all. They are not our customers; though they may work for some customers.